



Talk Light Trigger

Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

Listens to a talkback mic/bus input and fires a dLive Scene recall whenever the level crosses a threshold — one Scene while quiet, a different one while talkback is active. Point each Scene's Surface Illumination at a different colour and the console's lights flash with talkback.

Menu bar icon

Click	Show / hide the control panel.
Right-click	Quit the app (there's no Dock icon or app menu — this is the only way to quit).
Icon colour	Grey = stopped. Blue = running, listening (quiet). Bright = talkback active.

Connection

Choose one. Both reach the console the same way underneath — pick whichever needs less new software.

Direct TCP	Opens its own connection to the MixRack. Enter the console's IP (Host) — Port defaults to 51325.
Existing MIDI Port	Sends over a MIDI port already routed to the console — most easily the free dLive MIDI Bridge , or A&H's driver / loopMIDI / IAC. Pick it from the dropdown. When the port is dLive MIDI Bridge, this app identifies itself by name ("Talk Light Trigger") in the bridge's MIDI Monitor instead of showing as a generic connection.
Base MIDI Channel	Must match Utility → Control → MIDI on the console.

Audio Input

Device	The audio interface carrying the talkback signal.
Channel	Which input channel on that device to listen to.

Scenes

Quiet Scene #	Scene recalled while the input is below threshold.
Talkback Scene #	Scene recalled while talkback is active.
Flash Rate	While talkback is active, the app alternates the Quiet and Talkback Scenes at this rate instead of holding on the Talkback Scene — the console lights actually flash.
Flash Hold	How long the flash carries on after talkback stops (default 3 s), so a short pause doesn't cut the lights off. Talking again inside the hold just keeps it going. Off = the flash follows the microphone exactly.

Important — on the console, save two Scenes with different dimmer values in Surface → Control → Dimmer. Both Scenes must have their Recall Filter restricted to Surface Illumination only. Without this, recalling either Scene changes the whole mix, not just the lights.

Sensitivity

Threshold	Level the input has to cross to count as "talking."
Attack Time	Time above Threshold required before it triggers (avoids brief noise/breath sounds).
Release	How far below Threshold the level must drop before counting as quiet again (avoids flicker at the edge).
Min Retrigger	Minimum time between Scene recalls, even if the level keeps crossing back and forth.



Cancel SoftKey

Needs **Direct TCP** or an **Existing MIDI Port** that can receive — not available when pointed at a MIDI Bridge lane. This is the only thing in this app that ever receives MIDI; audio input still decides quiet vs. talking on its own.

Enable	Listens for a console SoftKey to stop the flash the moment it's pressed.
Cancel CC #	The Control Change number your SoftKey sends (default 127).
What to type on the console	Set the SoftKey to Custom MIDI and type the string the panel shows, exactly — it updates as you change the CC # or Base MIDI Channel. It is three comma-separated hex bytes: B + (base channel – 1) in hex, the CC # in hex, then 01 . Base channel 12, CC 127 → BB,7F,01 ; base channel 1, CC 127 → B0,7F,01 .
Cancel Cooldown	How long the flash stays off after a press. It resumes on its own after this, if still talking — no need to press again.

Running it

Start / Stop	Opens (or closes) the audio input and begins (or stops) watching the level.
Status tile	Stopped / Quiet / Active — mirrors the menu bar icon colour.
First launch	macOS will prompt for microphone access the first time you click Start — allow it, or the app won't receive any audio.

Bitfocus Companion

Connects on 127.0.0.1:8771 — the “Bitfocus Companion” row in the panel shows whether it's connected.

Allow Companion control	On by default (this Mac only). Companion can press Run and adjust Threshold; turn off to stop accepting remote presses — the panel still shows why.
Lock show-critical controls	Off by default. When on, Companion can't switch Run off (turning it on remains available).
What Companion sees	Run/Threshold as buttons, plus Running, Talk state, Level, Threshold and both Scene numbers as variables and feedbacks.

If something goes wrong

Export log	Click Export log in the panel footer. A diagnostics zip lands on your Desktop and opens in Finder — this session's log, the previous one, and your settings (licence details removed). Send that zip with your report; nothing leaves your Mac unless you send it.
What the log holds	Your settings at launch and each change, the audio and MIDI devices present, every Start and Stop, every error the panel showed you, your licence or trial state. Every launch is logged automatically; nothing to switch on.
The log folder	Right-click the menu bar icon and choose Open Log Folder (~/ Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/Talk Light Trigger/ , newest 20 launches kept).
Send feedback	Also in the footer — a short message straight to me, no email client needed.



What's new in v1.2.0

- Now runs on macOS 11 Big Sur or later, as the store page has always said. Earlier versions needed macOS 13.3 or later — on macOS 11 to 13.2 the app failed to open, with no message.
- New: the lights now flash. While talkback is active the app alternates the Quiet and Talkback Scenes at a Flash Rate you set, instead of holding on the Talkback Scene. Flash Hold keeps them flashing for a set time after talkback stops (3 seconds by default; 0 is Off, to follow the microphone exactly), so a short pause doesn't cut them off, and talking again inside the hold just keeps the flash going.
- New: cancel the flash. The Cancel flash button under Start/Stop — or a console SoftKey assigned to Custom MIDI — turns the lights dark at once; flashing resumes on its own after a cooldown you set if talkback is still going. The Cancel SoftKey section shows the exact text to type into the console's Custom MIDI page, in large type, and updates it as you change the CC number or the base MIDI channel. The SoftKey needs Direct TCP or an Existing MIDI Port that can receive — it can't be received through a MIDI Bridge lane; the button works everywhere.
- Fixed: when sending through MIDI Bridge, the lights could stop responding after a couple of minutes without talkback, with "Send failed" in the status panel, until you pressed Stop and Start. MIDI Bridge closes a connection that has been quiet for two minutes, and Talk Light Trigger did not reconnect. It now reconnects by itself and the Scene goes out as normal.
- Fixed: when the Mac's audio system resets — installing an audio driver does this (Time Code Tool's installer is one), and so can waking from sleep — Start could fail every time with "Internal PortAudio error [PaErrorCode -9986]" until you quit and reopened the app, and an input that was already running could stop for good: the level froze where it was and, if talkback was on, the lights kept flashing until you pressed Stop. The app now refreshes its device list and opens your input as normal, and notices a stopped input within 3 seconds: it sets the lights to the Quiet Scene, reopens the input and carries on listening, and the status panel says what happened.
- Fixed: the Audio Input channel could not be set above 64, so channels on a larger interface (Dante, MADI) were out of reach. The Channel box now goes up to the last channel of the device you have selected — a channel you saved earlier for a bigger interface is left alone, not quietly reduced, so it is still there when you plug that interface back in — and if you pick one the device hasn't got, the message says so plainly.